



Spin a web, shoot a goal, take on some devious terrorists, or just read a book

PRO SOCCER CUP 2002

Ole!

Cashing in on the craze of the World Cup comes a title, which gloriously avoids all copyrights and franchises by misspelling names! *Pro Soccer Cup 2002* is the poor man's *FIFA 2002*.

When it comes to football, the *FIFA* pedigree of games is by far the greatest football simulation conceived. Sports games may have taken their time in evolving, but with each passing year, they've gotten increasingly complex and feature rich. You can record in-game videos and save them to an AVI file, or even take screenshots of that perfect overhead kick.

When compared to a franchise like *FIFA 2002*, *Pro Soccer Cup 2002* is a poor competitor. The game has limited production values, no big names endorsing it and it comes from an unknown developer whose Web page says 'PAGE UNDER CONSTRUCTION'! So there obviously was a lot to be skeptical of.

But surprisingly, it turned out to be a well-balanced game, which performed flawlessly in its limited scope of features. The gameplay was simple and engaging, and the passing system worked very well. The controls weren't too difficult and took only about 5 minutes to adapt to. Okay, the AI is a little weak and the gameplay



VIEW FROM THE TV BOX: Choose from eight camera views, including a third person view and a top down view

tactics lack variety, but it's still enjoyable. The game gets tougher by simply speeding up the reaction times. The difficulty level of the opponent depends on the team you are playing against. Each team has a skill percentile (Saudi Arabia had 40 per cent and Brazil had 100 per cent). In a 10-minute match, Brazil scored three goals against us, while we managed to beat Saudi Arabia 5-2, while playing as Argentina!

The graphics rates above average, with weather effects, instant replay, and eight camera modes. The stadiums were

decently rendered, and the players look realistic while tackling and dribbling the ball. The character animation surprises with its details—players would make victory dances when they scored a goal, while the goalie would kick his heels in frustration. The sound however, is quite poor; and there's no in-game commentary, just a rasping crowd chant that gets louder every time a player comes close to a goal. The rain

effects sound like the recording of a shower played over and over in an endless loop!

The multiplayer feature for a LAN game is the added bonus. All in all, the good outweighs the bad in this game.

Genre: Sports

Developer: Enigma

Distributor: World Wide CD ROMS

Phone: 022-6973894

Web site: www.enigmasp.com

Price: Rs 699

Rating: ★★☆☆☆

SOLDIER OF FORTUNE II: DOUBLE HELIX

Gore galore

Soldier of Fortune II (SOFII) is a great game if you have never played a First Person Shooter (FPS) before. However, if you have played an FPS before, you'll tire of all the FPS clichés in this game. But if you can look past the scripted levels and poor implementation of stealth, this game shines at what made the original *SOF*

successful—gun gameplay. The story revolves around a group of terrorists who develop a virus to release at the World Trade Summit in Switzerland and demand a huge ransom in return for the cure. You play as John Mullins, weapons specialist and military consultant, sent to uncover and foil their dastardly plan.

Though the game brags about its gore and damage locations, it would be just as good without the horror, and you can turn it off. Shooting people in different places with different weapons can be very disturbing. Hands, feet, shins, legs, spew out in bloody chunks—definitely not for those with a weak stomach!